

Villa Dalmacia Grant

The Villa Dalmacia Grants Program supports **local communities in Western Australia**, with a particular focus on communities of Southern European descent. The program provides funding for initiatives that promote **community welfare, social inclusion, and cultural heritage**.

Focus areas:

Improving Community Welfare

Funding for projects that address essential community needs, including health, education, wellbeing, and social support.

Enhancing Social Inclusion

Initiatives that reduce isolation and improve participation, particularly for people experiencing vulnerability, including older adults, refugees, and people with disability.

Preserving Cultural Heritage

Support for activities that celebrate, preserve, and share the cultural heritage of Southern European and other culturally diverse communities within Western Australia.

Supporting Marginalised Groups

Projects that uplift financially disadvantaged individuals, people at risk of homelessness, and those living with chronic or terminal illness.

TIMELINE AND ACTION ITEMS

Budget and funding details	Aden	20/05
ABN and website	Roddy, Freya	20/05
Get ABN – Freya	Freya	21/05
Pay for Domain	Freya (and Roddy)	21/05
Project plan	Sharna, Alex	22/05
Website live	Roddy	22/05
Breakdown of marginalised	Sharna	23/05
Canvas the Italian Club	Freya, Emma	24/05
Consider training options	Freya	25/05
Find/create letters of support/endorsement from suppliers and church that just need a signature	Ben, Freya, Alex	25/05
Anticipated impact Success matrix Project information	Freya	26/05
Write plan	Alex, Sharna	26/05
Next meeting		26/05
Deliver		30/05
Submit		31/05

Project Title:	Community of Kindness – the Ikigai of Fremantle				
Key Personnel	Name	Role	Qualifications and experience	Email	Phone number
	Freya Cheffers	The heart of the project	Fremantle Citizen of the Year 2026. Several years of personally advocating and putting herself on the frontline to alleviate the homelessness situation. Chef by trade.	freyacheffers@gmail.com	
	Emma James	Treasurer	Emma is a corrections officer at the Fremantle Adult Correction Centre - Law Courts and is near completion of a criminology degree. Emma has abundant experience managing projects and keeping moving parts on track.		
	Alexander Buck	Secretary, legal compliance	Alex is applying for admission to legal practice and is currently an assessments officer for the federal department of climate change, energy, the environment and water (DCCEEW). The WA equivalent, DWER, is administered by the Minister for the Environment and Homelessness. Freya and Alex's missions are closely aligned. Alex has prepared several business proposals and has been on several voluntary charitable boards.	acebucket@hotmail.com	0423137575

GRANT QUESTIONS:

Brief Background of Applicant/Organization

Freya Cheffers has dedicated many years to voluntary community service within the Fremantle community, supporting vulnerable and marginalised individuals through grassroots outreach, compassion, practical assistance, and ongoing acts of community care. Her contribution has been formally recognised by the City of Fremantle through the award of Community Citizen of the Year 2026 in recognition of her longstanding commitment to community wellbeing and social inclusion. (Refer to the Community Citizen of the Year nomination provided in the supporting documentation.)

Driven by a deeply human-centred philosophy grounded in dignity, kindness and inclusion, Freya has been developing the vision for “The Community of Kindness”, which has been framed by collaborators as “the Ikigai of Fremantle”: an emerging community-led initiative focused on strengthening social connection, practical support, wellbeing, and community resilience within Fremantle.

Over time, Freya’s grassroots “humanising” movement has gained strong organic support from volunteers, local residents, commercial suppliers, creatives, faith communities and community members who have joined together to support people experiencing homelessness, hardship and social isolation. Through recurring community meals, outreach efforts, informal support networks and acts of generosity, the initiative has already started building meaningful community participation and goodwill. (Letters of support from the Fremantle Mayor, local parish, and commercial sponsors willing to donate food and groceries are forthcoming and will be provided at the soonest).

Freya has independently organised numerous grassroots fundraising initiatives to support individuals and families experiencing severe hardship, trauma and crisis circumstances that no person should ever have to endure (see attached financial statements). In many instances, Freya has also personally opened her own home as a place of respite and temporary support for vulnerable individuals in need. The Community of Kindness will replicate this model, ensuring a sustainable boundary between Freya’s personal life and this communitarian effort.

These efforts have been driven not by institutional obligation, but by compassion, empathy and a strong commitment to restoring dignity, hope and human connection within the community. These initiatives have already helped alleviate the rough sleeping conditions (and their negative consequences) for a multitude of people across Fremantle, bringing hope and benefitting the community as a whole by (modestly) reducing the local homeless situation.

The Community of Kindness is currently progressing toward formal establishment as a community charitable organisation, with support from local volunteers and stakeholders seeking to create a safe, inclusive and purpose-driven community space where people can reconnect socially, access practical support, and participate in meaningful activities that foster dignity, belonging and hope.

Freya is connecting with past Citizens of the Year (awarded for similar work) to collaborate at co-creating this shared vision for a better Freo.

Brief Project Summary – purpose and scope

The Community of Kindness – the Ikigai of Fremantle is an emerging grassroots, community-led initiative seeking to establish a safe, welcoming and purpose-driven community hub in Fremantle for people experiencing social isolation, homelessness, hardship, or difficult life circumstances.

Ikigai is a Japanese concept that can be translated as “reason for being”, and it can be described as the intersection of:

- what one loves – to help others and create a better neighbourhood where everyone feels safer and everything is filled with magical beauty;
- what one is good at – Freya is phenomenal at helping others in her beloved community and at attracting the interest of everyone who stumbles upon this project (from the Fremantle Mayor to parish priests, business and bank owners, as well as the many volunteers (including long-standing Fremantle locals) that share, and are committed to helping materialise, her fantastic vision for the Community of Kindness.
- what one can make a living out of – there are many people who do not have a regular income and are facing homelessness who would love to make a living out of helping others and bettering the community. Who wouldn't?
- what the world needs – more kindness, compassion, “humaning”; less marginalised, vulnerable, isolated people.

We believe that the Community of Kindness embeds the passion, mission, vocation and profession of the true Fremantle culture, which has always been based on communitarian support for each other (we are, almost, all migrants, after all; we could all be one small step away from homelessness, after all). We believe the Community of Kindness is Freo's Ikigai.

The project aims to create an inclusive community environment where people from diverse backgrounds can find safety and stability, access practical support, connect socially, participate in community activities, develop skills, and contribute positively to the wider community.

The scope of the project includes the delivery of:

- recurring community meals and food support initiatives;
- safe and inclusive community gathering spaces;
- practical skills-sharing workshops and vocational pathway activities;
- wellbeing and peer-support activities;
- creative, cultural and intergenerational community engagement activities;
- community gardens and urban sustainability initiatives; and
- volunteer and community participation opportunities.

This all-inclusive initiative is designed to support not only individuals experiencing hardship, but also the broader Fremantle community by strengthening social cohesion, encouraging community participation, fostering multicultural connection, and promoting a more compassionate and human-centred local environment.

Project Goals that the project aims to achieve

The Community of Kindness – the Ikigai of Fremantle aims to strengthen community wellbeing, social inclusion and human dignity by creating a safe, welcoming and purpose-driven environment for vulnerable and socially isolated individuals within Fremantle.

The key goals of the project are to:

- Support improved mental health and emotional wellbeing through peer connection, creative activities and safe community engagement;
- Create a safe and inclusive community space, with all basic human amenities, that promotes dignity, belonging, participation and social connection;
- Reduce social isolation and improve wellbeing for people experiencing homelessness, hardship, trauma or difficult life circumstances;
- Foster stronger community cohesion through multicultural, intergenerational and community-led activities;
- Deliver recurring community meals and practical support initiatives that encourage connection, reciprocity and inclusion;
- Provide practical skills-sharing workshops, vocational pathways and opportunities for meaningful community participation and rehabilitation towards self-sufficiency;
- Encourage volunteering, mutual support and community contribution across diverse sections of the Fremantle community;
- Build collaborative partnerships with local organisations, suppliers, faith communities, volunteers and community stakeholders to strengthen long-term community resilience;
- Develop a sustainable, community-owned model that can continue growing beyond the grant period and contribute positively to the social fabric of Fremantle.

Target Beneficiary Group(s)

The Community of Kindness is designed to support a broad cross-section of the Fremantle community, with a particular focus on people experiencing vulnerability, social isolation, hardship or barriers to participation.

Target beneficiary groups include:

- People experiencing or looking at facing homelessness or housing insecurity;
- People experiencing financial hardship, trauma or difficult life transitions;
- People lacking community connection or support networks;
- Young people at risk of disengagement, isolation or social exclusion;
- Vulnerable creatives;
- People from culturally and linguistically diverse (CALD) backgrounds, including migrants and refugees;
- People experiencing mental health challenges, loneliness or emotional distress;
- People living with chronic illness, disability or other circumstances contributing to social disadvantage;

The initiative also aims to engage members of the broader community seeking opportunities for volunteering, community participation and positive social contribution in the local community.

Community Need Addressed and significance to the target community

Fremantle is experiencing increasing challenges relating to homelessness, social isolation, financial hardship, mental health struggles, and community fragmentation (see detail in the attached Business Plan). Many vulnerable individuals within the community experience barriers to accessing safe, welcoming and inclusive spaces where their basic needs are covered (a warm shower, a place to charge their phone or safely store their belongings), and where they can feel respected, connected and supported without judgement - human.

At the same time, existing frontline services are often under significant pressure, while many community members are seeking meaningful opportunities to contribute positively and strengthen local social cohesion.

The Community of Kindness – the Ikigai of Fremantle seeks to address this gap by creating a grassroots, community-led environment that combines practical support with human connection, inclusion and participation. The initiative is designed not only to assist people experiencing hardship, but also to foster a stronger, safer and more compassionate community for Fremantle as a whole.

The project responds directly to the needs of:

- people experiencing homelessness or housing insecurity;
- socially isolated individuals;
- people facing financial hardship or trauma;
- CALD community members seeking connection and inclusion;
- vulnerable individuals requiring practical support and safe community engagement opportunities; and
- community members seeking purpose, participation and positive social contribution.

The significance of the initiative lies in its human-centred and community-driven approach. Rather than focusing solely on crisis response, the project seeks to continue building long-term wellbeing, dignity and resilience through recurring community meals, peer connection, skills-sharing, volunteering, creative engagement and inclusive community participation.

The initiative also aims to strengthen Fremantle's broader sense of community by encouraging compassion, mutual support, multicultural connection and active civic participation. Through collaboration with volunteers, local businesses, commercial suppliers, faith communities and community organisations, the project seeks to create a sustainable and positive social impact that benefits both vulnerable individuals and the wider community by creating safer neighbourhoods.

What Impact Will the Grant Money Achieve? What positive outcomes or changes you expect this project to deliver for the target community)

The grant funding will help establish the foundational systems, partnerships and organisational capacity necessary for the Community of Kindness to grow into a sustainable, long-term community initiative capable of delivering ongoing social benefit within the community.

Funding from the Villa Dalmacia Grants Program will support the delivery of:

- weekly community gatherings and shared meals;
- volunteer coordination and community outreach;
- practical skills-sharing workshops (e.g. on De-escalation; Conflict Resolution; Drug and Alcohol Substance use and abuse; General Mental Health Support);
- the further development of the project's governance, organisational structure and community partnerships.

The initiative is expected to generate both immediate and long-term positive outcomes for the target community, including:

- reduced social isolation and increased sense of belonging for people;
- improved access to safe, welcoming and inclusive community spaces;
- strengthened community wellbeing, dignity and social connection;
- increased participation in volunteering, community activities and peer-support networks;
- improved engagement pathways for people experiencing homelessness or hardship;
- stronger multicultural and intergenerational community connection;
- increased community awareness, empathy and social cohesion within Fremantle;
- strengthened collaboration between local businesses, volunteers, faith groups, suppliers and community organisations;
- de-stigmatising homelessness and creating compassionate awareness in Fremantle and surrounding areas;
- entice more foot traffic in Fremantle.

The project also aims to reduce pressure on overstretched frontline services by creating an accessible, community-led environment focused on prevention, inclusion, participation and early support.

What Does Success Look Like, in concrete terms? How it will be measured. Include quantitative or qualitative metrics if possible

Success for The Community of Kindness will be measured through both quantitative outcomes and qualitative community impact.

The initiative aims to demonstrate meaningful improvements in social connection, participation, wellbeing, community engagement and practical support for vulnerable individuals in Fremantle.

Quantitative Measures

The project aims to achieve and measure:

- Delivery of weekly community lunch gatherings (in the center of Walyalup Koort over 12 months (continuing with existing weekly "Lunchies", with the intent of progressing towards a more permanent Community Center - work in progress);
- Currently, average attendance of 50+ participants per weekly session – measured with an attendance register / sign-in sheet;
- Volunteer participation – measured with a volunteer sign-in sheet and roster;
- Social inclusion – measured with first time participant engagements in the attendance register;
- Participants reporting improved wellbeing or connection – measured with informal wellbeing surveys, feedback forms and written/video testimonials;
- Celebrate music and art, and bringing Freo's true essence back;
- A variety of workshops (schedule tbc);
- Volume of community donations and number of community collaborations with local commercial businesses and in-kind suppliers (letters of support forthcoming);
- Organisational development – measured with registration documentation and governance records;
- Financial records.

Qualitative Measures

Success will also be measured through evidence of:

- Increased feelings of belonging, inclusion and social connection among participants;
- Improved participant wellbeing, confidence and sense of purpose;
- Positive community feedback and participant testimonials;
- Greater community awareness, compassion and understanding toward vulnerable individuals experiencing hardship or homelessness;
- Observable improvements in community participation, peer support and reciprocal volunteering;
- Positive feedback from local partners, suppliers, volunteers and community stakeholders;
- last but not least, enticing foot traffic back to Fremantle and making tourists and locals feel safe and happy.

Eventually, once the Community of Kindness is established, the project will develop into the opening of a 24/7 community center where people are protected from the elements and have access to all humaning amenities, such as toilets, warm showers, lockers, laundry, free art supplies (with the intent of having monthly fundraisers involving creatives who sleep rough and local artists), and an interactive community garden.

Long-Term Sustainability and Plans for Project Continuation – how will you continue sustaining the project beyond the grant period?

The Community of Kindness is intended to develop as a long-term, community-owned initiative grounded in volunteer participation, collaborative partnerships, community contribution and diversified funding sources.

The Villa Dalmacia grant funding will provide essential foundational support to help establish the organisational structure, governance systems, partnerships and recurring community activities required for long-term sustainability and future growth.

Beyond the grant period, the project aims to continue operating and expanding through a combination of:

- ongoing volunteer participation and community-led involvement;
- continued in-kind support from local suppliers, businesses, local government clergy and community;
- community fundraising initiatives and public donations;
- future grant applications and philanthropic support opportunities;
- strategic partnerships/collaborations with previous Citizens of the Year who are all on the same page with this communitarian vision;
- progressive formalisation of the organisation as an incorporated charitable entity.

The initiative is already demonstrating strong grassroots momentum through recurring community meals, volunteer engagement, supplier support and increasing community participation. This existing goodwill and community involvement provide a strong foundation for continued operation beyond the initial grant period.

As the project grows, the long-term vision includes the establishment of a stable and accessible community hub that can continue delivering:

- community meals and wellbeing activities;
- practical support services;
- creative and cultural engagement programs; and
- inclusive spaces promoting dignity, belonging and community resilience.

Are there any additional details or considerations that you feel Villa Dalmacia should know about your project? (optional)

The project team is deeply grateful for Villa Dalmacia's consideration and for the organisation's ongoing contribution to supporting inclusive, compassionate and community-driven initiatives across Western Australia.

We became aware of the Villa Dalmacia Community Grants Program on 14 May 2026 thanks to an advertisement on the Fremantle Herald. We have been tirelessly working around the clock and personal commitments to render on paper the vision for the Community of Kindness. We welcome the opportunity to discuss any further details in person.

We have in-principle committed support from several stakeholders, however we are yet to receive written letters of support due to limited time frame, but they are in process. We aim at submitting these for Villa Dalmacia's consideration in the first week of June.

Item	\$ Value	Description
ANB Registration	\$ 99	One off corporate cost
ACN Registration	\$ 600	Yearly corporate cost
Public Liability Insurance	\$ 1,200-5,000	Public Liability insurance quotes from \$1,200-5,000
Commercial Kitchen Hire	\$ 15,600	\$300 per week, times 50 weeks
Fuel and parking disbursements	\$ 3,120	\$20 for 3 vehicles, weekly
Food costs (including packaging and dry goods, spearate to in-kind donations) for weekly lunchies	\$ 7,800	\$150 per week
Musicians and Volunteer (donation for their commitment and dedication)	\$ 7,800	\$150 per week
Art supplies	\$ 1,040	\$ 20 per week
Musical instruments (maintenance)	\$ 1,000	Estimate: \$1,000
Miscellaneous	\$ 8,320	\$160 per week on basic homeless necessities such as stolen possessions (guesstimate).
Webite	\$ 50	\$50 per year
In-kind donations from suppliers and community	\$ 10,400	TBC. Roughly \$150-200 per week
TOTAL	\$ 60,829	

Project Plan

